

Conversation

#17

CONVERSATION

JOB INTERVIEW & CANDIDATE EVALUATION – MAKING THE RIGHT HIRE

Prepare 8 pieces of paper numbered from 1 to 8 and have each student draw one to discover their character.

This activity focuses on **interview language**, **professional storytelling**, **evaluation criteria**, and **decision-making**.

It's Wednesday morning at LogiSmart Brasil S.A., São Paulo.

The company is hiring a **Senior Operations Analyst** after a recent period of delays and performance issues.

The role is strategic: the new hire must improve processes, reduce costs, and support multiple departments.

Several interviewers are present, each with a different priority.

This interview will not only test the candidate — it will also reveal how aligned the leadership team really is.

Candidate Profile

Criteria	Candidate
Experience	7 years in logistics & operations
Previous company	Mid-size logistics firm
Key skills	Process improvement, data analysis
Leadership	Led small teams (4–6 people)
Salary expectation	R\$ 11,000
Availability	Immediate

Student Coaching – How to Use the Information

- Interviewers: ask **specific, realistic questions**
- Candidate: connect answers to **results and data**
- Use examples, not generic statements
- Decide if the candidate is a **fit or risk**

Characters

1. Lucas – Hiring Manager (Operations Director)

“This hire is critical for my team. We need someone practical, not theoretical.

I’m listening for clear examples and ownership. If the candidate avoids responsibility, I’ll notice.

I want someone who can start delivering in 30 days.”

2. Mariana – HR Recruiter

“My role is to assess behavior and culture fit. Skills matter, but attitude matters more.
I watch how the candidate answers pressure questions.
Honesty and self-awareness are key.
If something feels rehearsed, I’ll push deeper.”

3. Diego – Logistics Supervisor

“I care about day-to-day reality. Fancy answers don’t impress me.
I want to know if this person understands operations on the ground. If they’ve never handled real pressure, it will show.
I’m skeptical until proven otherwise.”

4. Sofia – Finance Manager

“This position impacts costs directly. I want to hear how the candidate saved money or improved efficiency.
Buzzwords won’t convince me. Numbers and results will.
I’m also watching salary expectations closely.”

5. Carla – Process Excellence Lead

“I focus on structure and methodology.
I want to know how this person analyzes problems. Clear thinking matters more than speed.
If the candidate can explain their process, that’s a good sign.
I’ll ask about failures as well as successes.”

6. Rafael – Risk & Compliance Officer

“I look for risk awareness. Fast solutions often create hidden problems.
I want to hear how the candidate handles mistakes and compliance. If they ignore risk, that’s a red flag.
Careful answers earn my respect.”

7. João – The Candidate

“I know this interview matters. I want to show confidence without sounding arrogant.
I have experience, but I also have gaps. If I’m honest, I believe that helps.
My goal is simple: show I can add value fast.”

8. Ana – Interview Coordinator

“I manage time and structure. Everyone must have space to ask questions.
At the end, I’ll summarize impressions.
If the discussion gets emotional, I bring it back to facts.”

Theme: **Evaluating a Job Candidate**

- 1 Describe the candidate and role requirements.
- 2 Explain the main concerns raised in the interview.
- 3 Present the final hiring decision and justification.
- 4 End with one lesson about recruitment or leadership.

Tone: professional and objective

Title: _____